



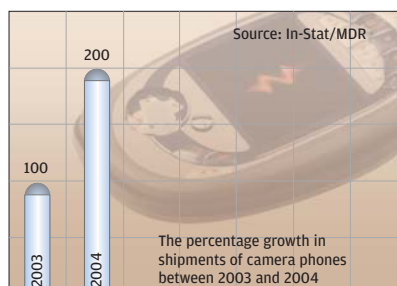
# Hold On! Let Me Click A Photo

**Forget the scandals over camera phones; this category can only get more and more popular**

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Of late, camera phones have caused quite a furore—unfortunately, for the wrong reasons—and have been the subject of much apprehension. One thing is for sure, though. They have quietly slipped into our daily life without us noticing.

It is also no secret that more and more people now prefer to buy camera phones as against regular ones. Increasingly buyers have started to base their buying decision on this parameter rather than the reception quality of the handset. With industry bigwigs such as Reliance offering camera phones at as low a price as Rs 6,500, the penetration is all set to rise further.



Camera phones, when combined with services such as GPRS, make a potent communication tool. Thanks to these contraptions, you can now send a photograph of your newborn to anybody at the press of a button.

Such convenience leverages their value from a luxury item to a must-have device.

## The Past

The first camera phone was introduced in Japan by a leading mobile operator belonging to the Vodafone group and was manufactured by Sharp. That was four years ago and since then a lot of water has flowed under the bridge. Today, even entry-level models from Nokia, Sony-Ericsson, Motorola and others offer basic imaging capabilities and some are also offering video capture and/or viewing capabilities and image editing software.

The early camera phones were limited in their effectiveness due to the limited number of colours produced on a phone screen. The storage capacity was also limited, hampering their capabilities and the price, restrictive.